

Investigation 1 – Types of data

Here are some examples of each type of data.

Categorical

- hometown
- hair color
- music genre
- breed of dog

Ordinal

- ranking a movie from 1 to 10
- answering 1, 2, 3, or 4 depending on how much you agree with a statement
- which year of the MYP (1 to 5) you are in

Continuous

- hair length of students in the class
- gas mileage of cars
- how far you travel to get to school
- time taken to run 100 m

Discrete

- number of students in a class
- how many pets your family has
- points scored in a bossaball game
- shoe size



- 1 Write down samples of the type(s) of data that could be collected for each example. For example, breed of dog data could be Labrador, Border Collie, Chihuahua, Siberian Husky, etc.
- 2 Based on the examples, write a definition of each data type: categorical, ordinal, discrete, and continuous.
- 3 Compare your definitions with those of other people. If necessary, refine your definitions based on what you found.

- 4 Classify each of the following types of data as either quantitative or qualitative and state which subcategory it falls under (categorical, ordinal, discrete or continuous).

- Types of game played by children
- Hours of on-screen time spent per week
- Types of boat on a lake
- Ranking your favorite sports
- Eye color of all the students in your class
- Weights of newborn babies in a hospital
- Heights of all bossaball players in a tournament
- Population of a country
- Languages spoken by students at your school
- Number of a person's siblings

- 5 Give your own example of each type of data.

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205, 206

